

Classic DIY Leche Flan

A rich, melt-in-your-mouth Filipino caramel custard celebrated for its silky consistency.

Prep Time: 20 mins	Cook Time: 35 mins
Chill Time: 4 hours+	Servings: 4–6

Ingredients

For the Caramel:

- 1 cup granulated white sugar
- 3 tbsp water

For the Custard:

- 10 large egg yolks (only the yolks for maximum richness)
- 1 can (395 g) sweetened condensed milk
- 1 can (354 mL) evaporated milk
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- A pinch of salt

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. Make the Caramel Base

In a small saucepan, combine the sugar and water over medium-low heat. Do not stir the mixture; instead, occasionally swirl the pan to ensure it melts evenly. Cook until the sugar dissolves and transforms into a deep golden amber syrup. Immediately pour the hot caramel into your baking pan or traditional metal *llaneras*. Tilt the mold to coat the entire bottom base evenly, then set it aside to cool and harden.

2. Prepare the Custard

In a large bowl, place the 10 egg yolks. Whisk them very gently using a fork or balloon whisk in a slow, circular motion. *Do not beat vigorously—you want to avoid creating any foam or trapped air bubbles.* Gradually pour in the sweetened condensed milk, evaporated milk, vanilla extract, and a pinch of salt. Mix smoothly until uniform. Pour the custard mixture through a **fine-mesh sieve or cheesecloth** directly into your caramel-lined pans. Straining is the essential secret to removing foam and egg fragments for a smooth finish.

3. Steam and Set

Cover the top of your molds tightly with aluminum foil to prevent condensation droplets from falling onto the custard. Set up your steamer and bring the water to a gentle boil. Place the covered molds inside, lower the heat to medium-low, and steam for **30 to 35 minutes**. *Note: Ensure the water is not boiling violently, as excessive heat creates holes in the flan.* Check for doneness: The center should look set but still retain a slight, gentle jiggle when shaken.

4. Cool and Unmold

Remove the molds from the steamer and let them cool completely to room temperature. Transfer them to the refrigerator and chill for **at least 4 hours** (overnight yields the cleanest slices and best caramel sauce). To serve, run a thin knife gently around the inside edges of the mold to loosen the custard. Place a rimmed serving plate upside down over the mold, firmly grasp both, and flip them over in one quick motion. Lift the mold, and let the golden caramel sauce cascade over the top.